

NHS OUTLOOK

What was published, compared with the pre-release outlook

8 newly published results can be compared with genuine pre-release forecasts. 6 fell inside their 80% expected range; 4 were better than forecast and 4 were worse.

08 October 2026

8 indicators

Release months differ by measure; each row is dated.

INDICATOR	PREVIOUS	OUTLOOK	ACTUAL
URGENT CARE			
A&E four-hour performance 95% constitutional standard 14 favourable · 33 adverse provider signals	75.0% Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	75.9% Sep 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 74.0%–77.7%	74.4% Sep 2026 1.5pp worse than outlook · inside the 80% range
Category 2 ambulance response 18-minute standard 0 favourable · 3 adverse provider signals	28.9 min Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	30.9 min Sep 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 24.2 min–36.1 min	31.3 min Sep 2026 0.4 min worse than outlook · inside the 80% range
PLANNED CARE			
RTT within 18 weeks 92% constitutional standard 79 favourable · 10 adverse provider signals	65.4% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	64.7% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 63.5%–66.0%	65.2% Aug 2026 0.5pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
Diagnostics waiting over six weeks 1% operational standard 49 favourable · 44 adverse provider signals	23.1% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	25.2% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 22.7%–27.2%	24.7% Aug 2026 0.5pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
Cancer treatment within 62 days 85% constitutional standard 29 favourable · 25 adverse provider signals	71.2% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	70.7% Aug 2026 · Broadly stable 80% range 68.9%–72.3%	71.9% Aug 2026 1.2pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
COMMUNITY			
Two-hour urgent community response 70% national standard 15 favourable · 8 adverse provider signals	85.3% Aug 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	86.1% Aug 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 85.6%–86.9%	85.5% Aug 2026 0.6pp worse than outlook · outside the 80% range
Community waiting list within 18 weeks 80% by March 2029 9 favourable · 8 adverse provider signals	75.9% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	75.3% Aug 2026 · Deterioration expected 80% range 74.2%–76.3%	75.8% Aug 2026 0.5pp better than outlook · inside the 80% range
MENTAL HEALTH			
Talking Therapies within six weeks 75% national standard Provider trajectory watch not available	83.8% Jul 2026 Baseline when outlook was made	85.2% Aug 2026 · Improvement expected 80% range 83.4%–86.7%	83.4% Aug 2026 1.8pp worse than outlook · outside the 80% range

How to read this. Outlooks are one-month-ahead forecasts made only with information available before release. The 80% range reflects historic one-step forecast errors. Provider signals compare actual performance with a path fixed six months earlier; they are prompts for review, not rankings.

Sources. NHS England A&E attendances and emergency admissions · NHS England Ambulance Quality Indicators · NHS England referral to treatment waiting times · NHS England diagnostic waiting times and activity · NHS England cancer waiting times · NHS England two-hour urgent community response · NHS England community health services waiting lists · NHS Talking Therapies monthly statistics. Planning milestones and standards are cited in each indicator deep dive.